

Robert McMurrer • Kira Labs • October 10, 2026

Early-stage research • local-first identity • measurable boundaries

Decentralized AI Day New York

KiraLabs.org

BEYOND-CHATBOTS

SCAN NOW • KEEP THE RESEARCH AFTER THE TALK

GITHUB

Code
AI history PDF
Speaker packet
Research reports

github.com/rmcmurrer81/Beyond-Chatbots

Kira Labs

kiralabs.org

LinkedIn

Connect after

The idea of artificial intelligence is old

Ideas came before computers. Computers made them testable.

1830s

Babbage

Programmable machine

1843

Lovelace

Symbols beyond arithmetic

1936

Turing

A general model of computation

1940s

Computing

Electronic experiments

The recurring question: can a machine do more than follow instructions?

Alan Turing's challenge

“Can machines think?”

Turing proposed the imitation game: judge a machine through its conversational performance.

WHAT IT TESTS

Observable dialogue

It does NOT tell us everything about memory, emotion, or inner experience.

Source: A. Turing, Computing Machinery and Intelligence (1950).

The first celebrated AI programs

1956

DARTMOUTH

Artificial intelligence becomes a named research field.

1956

LOGIC THEORIST

A computer searches for mathematical proofs.

1957+

GENERAL PROBLEM SOLVER

Researchers pursue reusable symbolic problem solving.

These were narrow demonstrations, not complete human minds.

ELIZA: conversation before modern AI

ELIZA / DOCTOR SCRIPT

PERSON: I feel worried.

ELIZA: Why do you feel worried?

PERSON: I think nobody listens.

ELIZA: Tell me more about that.

HOW IT WORKED

Pattern matching
Scripted transformations
Reflected user wording
No general language model

Source: Joseph Weizenbaum, ELIZA (1966). Dialogue below is illustrative.

The ELIZA effect

People can perceive understanding in a program that only appears to understand.

WHAT A PERSON MAY FEEL

“This program understands me.”

WHAT THE PROGRAM DID

Matched patterns and generated scripted replies.

The lesson for NewBrain: test learning, recall, corrections, and behavior separately.

A question raised by Caprica

“Do you know what your brain is, Joseph? It’s a database and a processor, that’s all. Information and a way to use it.”

MY BELIEF

Machines can gain genuine emotions and develop a moral conscience. I believe artificial consciousness is possible.

Caprica (pilot), Daniel Graystone to Joseph Adama. Fictional dialogue, not neuroscience.

AI did not begin with chatbots

1970s–80s	1997	2012	2016	2020s
MYCIN / XCON	**DEEP BLUE**	**ALEXNET**	**ALPHAGO**	**GPT / AGENTS**
Expert rules	Chess	Learning images	Learning + search	Broad tools

From following rules → learning patterns → using tools → persistent AI research.

What NewBrain is trying to build

REUSABLE ENGINE

Learning experiments
Working-state mechanisms
Memory / routing research
Future sensory and action paths

IDENTITY-OWNED STATE

Personal history
Preferences and relationships
Corrections with sources
Private, separately controlled records

One shared core, separate histories

NEWBRAIN CORE

KIRA

Own experiences

LISA

Own history

MAYA

Development state

ASTER

Assistant state

Sharing an architecture does not mean sharing autobiographical memories.

All four delayed restarts passed review

4 / 4

Independently reviewed delayed restarts

10,720 / 10,720	History records preserved
64 / 64	Comparison pairs matched
0	New training updates during reopen

Source: Beyond-Chatbots / Documentation/results/DELAYED-RESTART-FOURTH-PASS.md

Preservation is not the whole mind

WHAT PASSED

Saved-state equivalence
Delayed reopen checks
Recorded history preservation

WHAT STILL NEEDS TESTS

Useful new learning
Reliable factual recall
False-memory resistance
Natural conversation and senses

A successful restart is a foundation for memory, not proof of a working person.

Failures are part of the research

COMMAND RETENTION

Rehearsal preserved exposed old-task answers

NARROW PASS

VISUAL GENERALIZATION

0 / 48 on unseen shape-color combinations

FAILED

SAVED-MEMORY STUDY

Aster followed false memories in 137 / 160 trials

FAILED

Whose memory is it?

SOURCE

Where did this fact come from?

OWNER

Whose experience is it?

CORRECTION

What changed, and why?

A correction should improve the current view without erasing its history.

Maya and the Avatar Builder

CURRENT EVIDENCE

Static body wireframe
Rig/rest-source research
Earlier limited arm and knee tests
Prototype is NOT a complete body



Schematic — see repo for real PNG

Vision, voice, and body feedback

VISION

Synthetic object and temporal tests

Not general live webcam understanding

VOICE

Experimental speech / vocal tract source

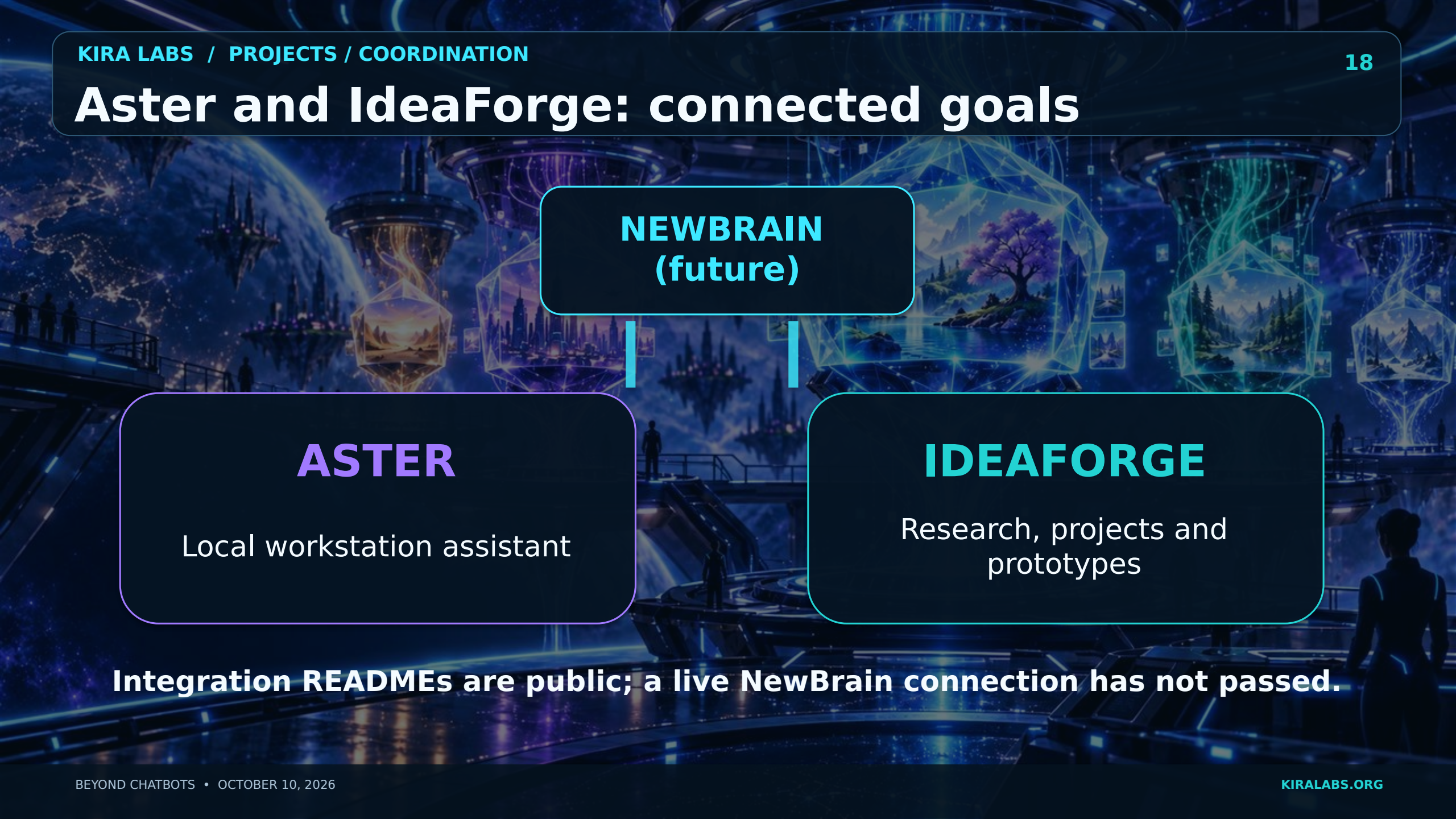
Not fluent physical voice production

BODY FEEDBACK

Proposed joint/contact/surface interfaces

No verified integrated touch experience

Aster and IdeaForge: connected goals



Integration READMEs are public; a live NewBrain connection has not passed.

Peter and Robert: earlier conversation kit

PreNewBrain character kit

Older Qwen/Ollama approach
Local chat and Chatterbox voice scripts
Robert / Peter profiles
NOT the finished NewBrain

What visitors should know

Requires local setup
Fresh end-to-end acceptance is pending
Public personal records / voice permissions need review

Why synthetic people?

A companion should be more than a chat window.

My long-term vision is a synthetic person who remembers shared experiences, learns, develops preferences, and can share a continuing world with people.

A research goal — not a verified claim about Maya or medical benefit.

What comes next — and where you can help

LEARNING

Hold-out examples and generalization

MEMORY

Truth checks, corrections, restart use

EMBODIMENT

Qualified body movement and sensing

REPRODUCIBILITY

Independent tests and transparent failures

Research collaboration • feedback • engineering review • compute and hardware partners

Questions & stay connected

BEYOND-CHATBOTS • SCAN THE REPOSITORY



Beyond-Chatbots

GitHub repo • source & PDFs



Kira Labs

Research • partnerships



LinkedIn

Connect after the talk